

25.9 Food Security and PDS

The state's Public Distribution System covers approximately 23.67 lakh ration cardholders across three categories: AAY (Pink, ultra poor) with 1.84 lakh families receiving 35 kg per card; PHH (White, NFSA) with 12.14 lakh families receiving 5 kg per unit; and SFY (Yellow, State) with 9.69 lakh families receiving 7.5 kg per card. The system operates through 9,063 Fair Price Shops, all equipped with e-PoS (100 per cent automated, biometric). One Nation One Ration Card was implemented in 2020. A Grain ATM has been piloted in Dehradun in collaboration with UN-WFP. The Devbhoomi Parivar ID serves as the digital PDS backbone, enabling ration portability.

Nutritional Add-ons in PDS

Item	Details
CM Dal Poshit Yojana	2 kg subsidized pulses/month (AAY+PHH)
CM Namak Poshan	Fortified salt at Rs 8/kg
Fortified Rice	B-12, Folic Acid, Iron (PM Poshan)
Mandua (Millet)	1 kg free/month to PHH (nutrition + hill farmer support)
CM Antyodaya Gas Refill	3 free LPG cylinders/year (1.84 Lakh AAY families)

25.10 Soldiers' Welfare (Sainik Kalyan)

Him Prahari Scheme

The Him Prahari scheme aims to settle ex-servicemen in ghost villages along the China and Nepal border. It serves a dual objective: stopping migration and creating a first line of defence. The scheme targets ex-servicemen and local youth in Pithoragarh, Chamoli, and Uttarkashi, providing settlement assistance and a "Border Guard" honorarium (approximately Rs 5.45 crore pilot). Participants serve as "eyes and ears" for security agencies while also providing community monitoring.

UPNL (Uttarakhand Purv Sainik Kalyan Nigam)

The UPNL budget for 2026-27 is Rs 289.98 crore. Its purpose is to ensure equal pay for equal work for contract workers, who are mostly ex-servicemen dependents. The corporation provides vocational training, skill rehabilitation, and civilian re-employment services to the approximately 1.38 lakh veterans in the state.

Other Soldiers' Welfare Measures

Financial grants for gallantry award winners have been hiked. The compassionate appointment window has been extended from 2 to 5 years, with 28 martyrs' families given jobs. Free state transport has been codified for gallantry winners and ex-servicemen. The Eco-Task Force deploys military-led afforestation battalions.

25.11 Disaster Rehabilitation

U-PREPARE Project

The U-PREPARE project is funded at Rs 1,480 crore by the World Bank for the period 2024 to 2029. It focuses on pre-disaster structural resilience rather than just post-disaster relief. Targets include retrofitting 45 bridges, improving 8 roads, constructing 10 disaster shelters, building 19 fire stations, and constructing an SDRF building.

🔗 27.3 EDUCATION SYSTEM PROBLEMS AND CHALLENGES

The "Himalayan distance penalty" and mass out-migration (Palayan) have created deep structural bottlenecks that make Uttarakhand's education challenges fundamentally different from plain-area states.

🔗 Master Problem Table

Problem	Nature	Scale / Data
Ghost Teachers	Teachers appointed to remote schools live in plains; sub-let duties to unqualified locals	Severe governance failure; "No work-No pay" policy introduced
Single-Digit Enrollments	Mass migration emptied hill primary schools	826+ schools permanently closed over 5 years; 2,655 schools run on single teacher
Single Teacher Schools	Critical shortage of educators in remote areas	2,655 primary schools; 28,000+ students pedagogically vulnerable
Stalled School Mergers	"Cluster Schools" policy announced but infrastructure within 5–10 km stalled	Terrain difficulties and administrative delays
Human-Wildlife Conflict	Wildlife attacks disrupt children's schooling in rural areas	Critical need for transport support and closer schooling
Topographical Accessibility	Plain-area population thresholds fail to account for "distance penalty"	Strong demand for hill-specific norms
Contractualization	Increasing contractual teachers and Class IV workers	Impacts job security and institutional stability
RTE Implementation Gaps	Delayed payments, "neighborhood tracking" difficulties in sparse habitations	Private schools face long delays in per-child reimbursements
Infrastructure Deficits	Many schools lack safe drinking water, functional girls' toilets, boundary walls	"PEVD Paradox" (Planning-Execution-Verification-Delivery failure)
Learning Poverty	Rote-based curriculum; students not trained in local value chains	Despite high literacy, employability remains low
Emerging Social Threats	Rising drug/alcohol usage among youth	Threatens to derail demographic dividend
Budget Surrenders	Departments return unspent allocations while infrastructure gaps persist	₹2,366 crore returned by departments

🔗 A. The "Ghost Teacher" Phenomenon

The "Ghost Teacher" phenomenon involves teachers appointed to remote hill schools who live in the plains and sub-let their duties to unqualified locals for a fraction of their salary, severely compromising education quality in remote areas. Tech-driven reforms now require geo-fenced, biometric attendance via the Apni Sarkar portal, with salary linked to physical presence at school coordinates. The "No work-No pay" policy makes salary strictly conditional on verified attendance. CCTV-based attendance verification has been introduced, while the Shailesh Matiyani Awards provide honors, cash prizes, and 2-year service extensions for outstanding educators.

🔗 Cooperative Banking — The PACS Revolution

The state has 671 multipurpose Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS), all of which have been computerized — making Uttarakhand the first state in India to achieve 100% PACS computerization. Of these, 310 PACS function as Jan Suvidha Kendras (e-governance hubs) and 23 PACS provide generic medicines as Jan Aushadhi Kendras. The cooperative system offers 0% interest loans of up to ₹1 Lakh for individuals and ₹5 Lakh for SHGs. Total deposits in the cooperative sector amount to ₹15,65,145 Lakh.

🔗 Role of NABARD

Initiative	Impact
RIDF	15,984 km roads built; 2.45 Lakh hectares irrigated
SHG-Bank Linkage	55,444 SHGs linked; ₹1,238.55 Crore credit
FIDF	Concessional finance for fisheries/trout infrastructure

🔗 Financial Inclusion

Under PM Jan-Dhan Yojana (PMJDY), 39.53 Lakh accounts have been opened with deposits of ₹3,062.64 Crore and 25.78 Lakh RuPay cards issued. PM Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY) has enrolled 49.71 Lakh people for accidental insurance, while PM Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY) covers 18.14 Lakh for life insurance. Atal Pension Yojana (APY) has 9.30 Lakh subscribers. The RBI Regional Office in Dehradun was established on June 30, 2006.

🔗 The CD Ratio Paradox

The overall Credit-Deposit Ratio stands at 54.67% (including RIDF). The highest ratio is in US Nagar at 119.42%, while the lowest is in Bageshwar at just 24.66%, followed by Almora at 26.97% and Pauri at 27.47%.

The CD Ratio asymmetry reveals a structural "Capital Flight" phenomenon — savings deposited by hill residents are diverted by banks to fund loans in the plains or outside the state. This starves hill districts of entrepreneurial investment, fuels Palaayan (outmigration), and creates a vicious cycle where lack of credit leads to lack of enterprise, which leads to lack of youth, which further reduces demand for credit.

🔗 Way Forward (Banking)

- **Digital Banking Units (DBUs):** Paperless units in every block
- **Bank-on-Wheels:** Mobile ATMs for disaster-affected and remote areas
- **Green Credit Framework:** Linking finance to GEP goals
- **District-specific credit targets:** Mandating hill-capital reinvestment into horticulture, trout, and MAPs
- **100% PACS computerization** already achieved — next step: CBS integration

🔗 23.2 ENERGY & POWER INFRASTRUCTURE

🔗 The Energy Paradox

Uttarakhand possesses a hydroelectric potential of approximately 25,000 MW but has an installed capacity of only about 4,045 MW. Total generation stands at 16,500 MU (4.3 times the 2001 level), while total consumption has reached 17,192 MU (6 times the 2001 level) — meaning the state consumes more than it generates. Household electrification has achieved 100% coverage, up from 60% in 2000-01. Solar capacity stands at 861-1,027 MW. The state's power transmission infrastructure is exemplary: PTCLIL records transmission losses of just 1.02%, system availability of 99.72%, and AT&C losses reduced from 44.82% to

🔗 28.5 MODERNIZATION AND EMERGENCY LOGISTICS

The government is aggressively shifting toward technology-led solutions to bypass the "Golden Hour" geographic penalty. Uttarakhand uses a three-tiered "Air-Bridge Strategy" to overcome terrain: HEMS (helicopters) for critical trauma and maternity emergencies, drones for blood components and medicines to cutoff zones, and e-Sanjeevani (telemedicine) providing 15.15 lakh consultations connecting villages to city specialists. This "Phygital" model ensures healthcare reaches patients even when roads are blocked by landslides or monsoon damage.

🔗 Emergency and Logistic Initiatives

Initiative	Details
Heli-Emergency Medical Service (HEMS)	Uttarakhand is the first state in India to launch helicopter-based emergency services from AIIMS Rishikesh; ensures air-lifts during "Golden Hour" from remote hills
Drone Medical Service	AIIMS Rishikesh pioneers regular drone delivery of blood components, anti-venoms, and medicines to remote/cutoff zones
e-Sanjeevani (Telemedicine)	Network of 1,500 'spokes'; conducted over 15.15 lakh virtual consultations; connects rural patients to city specialists
Mobile Medical Units (MMUs)	5 units deployed in Haridwar, US Nagar, and Tehri Garhwal for doorstep primary care
108 Jeevan Vahini	ALS and BLS ambulances stationed at rugged bottlenecks; free critical patient transport
Khushiyon Ki Sawari	Fleet of ambulances providing free transport for pregnant women; 40,000+ beneficiaries
Doli Seva	Financial support for transporting patients on manual stretchers (litters) in roadless areas
Tele-MANAS	Mental health tele-counseling cells operationalized in Srinagar and Almora medical colleges

🔗 28.6 NATIONAL HEALTH MISSION (NHM) AND AYUSHMAN BHARAT

🔗 A. National Health Mission (NHM)

NHM serves as the operational backbone for rural healthcare delivery, focusing on infrastructure upgrades and maternal-child safety. Under NHM, 1,554 Ayushman Arogya Mandirs have been established out of a target of 2,160, providing comprehensive primary care. Infrastructure includes 1,914 Sub-Centres, 524 PHCs (Type A), and 81 CHCs. Institutional deliveries have reached 93.86% (up from 30% in 2000) and the MMR has declined by 80% since state formation. NCD screening through door-to-door visits targets 17.50 lakh individuals for diabetes, hypertension, and cancer. The innovative "You Quote, We Pay" programme allows specialist doctors to bid their own salary (up to ₹6 lakh/month) to serve in remote districts.

🔗 B. Ayushman Bharat — Atal Ayushman Uttarakhand Yojana (AAUY)

Uttarakhand was among the earliest states to expand the national Ayushman Bharat mission into a universal state-wide program. Unlike the national scheme which covers selected BPL/vulnerable groups, AAUY provides universal coverage to all permanent residents of the state. Approximately 60 lakh Ayushman "Golden Cards" have been issued, providing ₹5 lakh per year per family for cashless treatment. The budget allocation stands at ₹600 crore in the latest cycle. The scheme has shifted from a trust-based model to an insurance-based, audit-heavy model to reduce inflated billing by private hospitals, standardize claim procedures, and improve financial discipline.